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Resume Success

Your resume must clearly, concisely and strategically present your qualifications to get a recruiter interested in meeting you. It should convey your skills, work experience and assets. The resume is used to describe what you can accomplish professionally in a manner that also illustrates what you can do for an employer. Job opportunities can arise unexpectedly. An updated modern resume is the key to a successful job search. Here are some do's and don'ts of how to write a good resume and what to include.

Keep your resume clear and concise
An employer takes an average of 30 seconds to skim a resume. You want them to see right away that you are qualified for the position.

Proofread your resume numerous times
Be sure there are no mistakes. Have someone else read it over as well. A simple spelling mistake on a resume can give a negative impression to the employer. It can even prevent you from getting the job.

Limit your resume to one page
Place the emphasis of your resume on your most recent experience. Older jobs and experience that are more than 15 years old should either be cut out or minimized. This way, the employer can focus on more relevant information.

Tailor your resume to suit the position you are applying for

Specify work experience or achievements that are related to the position using multiple industry focused resumes.This can be done by reviewing the job description or the employer website.

Highlight what you have accomplished

You want to be able to identify the best examples of where you demonstrated your skills. These examples should speak to what you achieved in your role, and should demonstrate what kind of employee you are. It is best to include this information in the "Work experience" section of the resume using measured results.

Be honest

Inflating results on your resume is never a good idea. You don't want to overstate your skills or results as it will mislead the employer. Have confidence in what you have to offer.

Quantify your achievements

Use firm numbers that the employer will understand and be impressed by. For example, how many people you supervised, how many products you sold, by what percentage you increased sales, reduced cost.

Use simple words and action verbs

The person reading your resume might not always be the employer. Resumes can be reviewed by recruiters or managers who may not be familiar with your specific field. Use simple and plain language, but also persuasive verbs such as handled, managed, led, developed, increased, accomplished, leveraged.

Include activities that show off your skills

If you have volunteered with a well-known organization or worked for an important cause, put it in your resume. You should include these experiences under the "Work experience" or the "Volunteer work" section, especially if they are related to the position you are applying for.

Double check and include your contact information

Your resume should list your name, address, email and phone number. This information should be placed at the top of the first page. Also, make sure this information is accurate. Otherwise, the employer won't be able to contact you.

Don't include unnecessary personal information

It is best to leave out any personal details such as age, weight, height, marital status, religious preference, political views, or any other personal attributes that could be controversial. This will prevent any potential bias. Most importantly, never include your Social Insurance Number in your resume.

Don't use too many bullets
Make your resume easy to read by limiting each resume section or sub section to 5-7 bullet points. This will make it easier for the employer to scan your resume and identify your potential. Each bullet point should be used wisely by keeping the information relevant and concise.

Don't use personal pronouns
Do not use "I," "my," or "me". Write your resume in the third person, as if it's being written by someone else.

Don't simply list job responsibilities
Your job duties will be obvious from your job title. Instead, highlight your achievements by putting a personal spin on your job duties and providing specific examples.

Don't make general statements

Steer clear from vague statements that don't highlight your actual contribution. Unclear statements such as, Responsible for improving efficiencies and making cost savings", does not provide any information to an employer. Personalize your experience!

Don't include reasons for leaving previous jobs

The main purpose of your resume is to promote you, your skills, experience and achievements. It should be entirely positive, and therefore should not include reasons for leaving as it does not add any value to you as a candidate.

Don't include hobbies or interests
It is not recommended to mention hobbies because of the judgments potential employers can make. However, if your hobbies relate to the position, you may include them as they can demonstrate to the employer why you are a good fit.

ATS Guide

Relevant Keywords: Incorporate keywords commonly used in job descriptions. Ensure these keywords are connected to your unique experiences and skills.
Skills Section: A dedicated skills section can highlight your expertise and make your resume stand out.
Use simple language to avoid overly complex or technical jargon.

Write Out Acronyms: If you use acronyms in your resume, make sure to write them out explicitly to avoid confusion.

Submit a Customized Resume: For each job application, create a tailored resume that showcases your relevant experience and skills.

Use Basic Formatting: Maintain a clean and professional layout for your resume. Avoid excessive formatting or unnecessary embellishments.